



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 37

OKLAHOMA

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Oklahoma's family courts and child-welfare system.

57

OKLAHOMA FAMILIES ON RECORD ·
98 CHILDREN IMPACTED · 12 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 29, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
19 OF 77

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

OKLAHOMA AT A GLANCE.

Across 57 Oklahoma families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 98 55 of 57 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$20,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 12 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 47.4% 42.1% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 57	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 1.8	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 55 of 57	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 19

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Oklahoma families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF OKLAHOMA FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	39	\$20,000	\$39,410	\$1,537,000
Lost Wages	29	\$15,000	\$53,276	\$1,545,000
Other Court Fees	17	\$1,000	\$8,863	\$150,675
Therapy / Evaluations	28	\$2,000	\$6,964	\$195,000
Reunification Services	21	\$2,000	\$2,528	\$53,085
GAL Fees	25	\$5,000	\$11,584	\$289,600
Asset Loss ¹	24	\$42,500	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$87,500	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$42,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		12	1 yr
Mean months lost		25	2.1 yrs
Total across all families		957	79.8 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · OKLAHOMA

Most families documenting in Oklahoma are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		21	37%
Not provided		16	28%
Case closed: within last 2 years		9	16%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		6	11%
Not in court but still affected		1	2%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and CPS		25	44%
Family Court Only		17	30%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		8	14%
Unknown		5	9%
Judicial Abuse / Retaliation		1	2%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		20	35%
5 – 10 years		12	21%
6 months – 1 year		6	11%
3 – 5 years		4	7%
Over 10 years		4	7%

CUSTODY STATUS

Visitation Only		17	30%
No Contact / Total Loss of Access		15	26%
Full Custody		8	14%
50/50 Joint		7	12%
Children in Foster Care		6	11%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Tulsa		4	7%
Creek		3	5%
Oklahoma		2	4%
Pottawatomie		2	4%
Cleveland		2	4%
Okmulgee		2	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		20	35%
Other: (Short answer)		7	12%
High Conflict Divorce		6	11%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		5	9%
Other		4	7%

05 PARENT VOICES — OKLAHOMA

Selected voice excerpts appear here for readability. Every approved, shareable Oklahoma comment is printed in full in the appendix that follows.



Took my children away for 21 days with no contact with me or them, separated my children, didn't care to listen to my case, gave my kids to an abuser, mental anguish towards my children and I.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

My children are being told that their parents are unsafe. My family is falling apart, my son has no idea who his parents are. There is no proof or evidence supporting their claims to my children. Our children are traumatized. My husband and I are exhausted and so sad that we [...]

— OKLAHOMA PARENT · ANASTASIA

MORE VOICES FROM OKLAHOMA

This system destroyed my relationships with my three children irreparable harm has been done and there isn't a way to fix it.

— KATIE

It has destroyed my relationship with my children. It has destroyed me financially and emotionally.

— RAY

They have stripped us of any human rights we thought we had. And destroyed our mental health. What has been taken can never be replaced. We grasp at the few strands of hope that float through the time we are allowed to have with our children.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex husband was abusive which had been proven, he was also a very absent father after the divorce to our 4 children, he got really behind on child support & refused to pay, so he showed up took our teen son (which was just turning 13 at the time) used him as a weapon against [...]

— BRANDY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



At 13 my son wanted to live with his dad in another state. Now at 15 he reports abuse and a strong desire to return home and he is being silenced and not allowed to share his story with the judge. We've been in a holding pattern for nearly 3 years with a bias GAL awaiting trial.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Taken my children's childhood and my chance at being their mother without the chaos and trauma of their father and his hatred towards me.

— KRYSTAL

My biggest regret in life is telling the truth and following the law. I reported abuse. My family has been destroyed as a result.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The judge said get along or your children will rebuild and grow up in the system. I was told one of us had to love our children enough to let go. I just didn't realize it would cost me again for the rest of my life.

— DEBRA

stripped me of feeling human. "The hardest part isn't even what happened between us—it's how it affected my relationship with my kids."

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My son was illegally kidnapped from me by my abuser, because of his private connections with the Judge. I don't know if I'll ever get to see my son again. The Judge threatened this from day one. My life will never be the same. I don't know how much longer I can fight. I've lost [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Going in to this situation, my daughter and I had a healthy, fun and easy going relationship. This ongoing situation has completely destroyed our father/daughter relationship. It has caused extreme emotional duress, strained my marriage, damaged my reputation, and ruined my [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have ruined my life and my relationship with my children.

— SHAUN

The system took my kids and gave them to my ex who was beating them and had charges on him for beating kids and will not work with me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



They stole my granddaughter and told the foster parents they could adopt her while my granddaughters parents still had their parental rights.

— JAMIE

This system has lied and manipulated over and over. Destroyed my kids future and their belief of their mom. They'll never believe the actual truth because they've brain washed them!!

— CRYSTAL

Destroyed me and my sons relationship, my son and daughters relationship, stolen time and memories that we will never get back. Stolen my son's entire childhood from me.

— KATLYN

Destroyed, shattered but we're strong and we will survive and be stronger. The pain and suffering is unimaginable

— KIMBERLY

Took my son from me and said they could protect and care for him better than I could. Then they allowed him to leave their "safe and secure" environment while mentally unstable, and he was killed while in CPS custody. Kota ☐ forever 17

— JOLLEEN

My entire life to enjoy was stolen trying to defend myself. Now my grandchildren have tried to kill themselves because they have used a false substantiated that dismissed. They can't seem to have a system to correct errors

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

We have been informed that CPS, the judge AND "my" public defender (I have not met the judge or the public defender yet) have already met and made agreements before I even got to court. I have been subpoenaed to hand over my kids before I have even been in court or received a [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Removed me from my home for over 4 months. Taken away all parenting rights to my daughter. Separated me from my step children for the past 4 months.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Children were sold to my ex whom wanted revenge on for leaving them. I am my children's only biological family,

— DOMINIQUE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



It has complete destroyed us completely..

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has tore my family apart, my 4 year old under the influence that her home is unsafe and can not come home because of it. My kids feel as if their mother and I don't love them anymore because they have been out of the home for so long.

— DENZIL

Removed children ex parte with no evidence and no third party statements that children were at risk with me in any way, then given to a third party who never requested guardianship.

— HOPE

It has destroyed our life, our health, our stability, our safety, and our peace. It has stolen our joy, my son's innocence, childhood, and my motherhood.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My children are now scared of law enforcement officers after being taken at gunpoint with no warrant and given to the abusers parents with an ex parte guardianship

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The courts let him continue to abuse us by using the system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Severed and destroyed the mother/child bond. Caused severe emotional & mental health injuries. Harmed extended family members and countless other personal relationships.

— JEANA

They have done a grave injustice toward my family, torn apart by lies and corruption ,and they need to face justice for what they've done to countless families like my own.

— MISTY

The Court has severed a loving and nurturing relationship between a devoted father/parent and his children, inflicting profound emotional harm while unjustly destroying his reputation and destabilizing his financial life.

— FRANKIE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



They tore my family apart... and left me to be swallowed up by the system. I'm staying strong in my belief. God will make a way

— ROBERT

The system failed me and my family.

— CHELSEY

Caused irreplaceable harm, lost previous memory building time, created a chasm in the family relationship

— SUZANNE

Family court has shown me that children and families come last. They have facilitated and enabled conflict that has cost me and my daughter years and tens of thousands of dollars.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Ever since my child was born, even before I've been a domestic abuse situation. The reason I left their situation is because the father my child threatened to kill my grandparents while he was drunk, waving a gun in the air, which pointed at me and my son and I had to grab the [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has torn my family apart and made me miss out on my only child's life and her most important moments in life and it has made me think of committing suicide. I am lost without my child and she is my reason for living and to be able to have someone who isn't related to your [...]

— FRANCIS

The family court system did not just fail me — it empowered coercive control, ignored financial abuse, and allowed narratives to replace evidence. I was painted as unstable and uncooperative while being denied access to critical financial information and meaningful due process. [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I refused to pay anything but I provided groceries, clothing and all my child needs. My case was very strange. It was the 1st that my child had ever been away from me and the only time she was ever neglected it abused was during her time in foster care. So many things they [...]

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I has threatend in front of my counsel who did not come to my aid but opposing counsel in an informal mediation I was pressured into that if I didnt accept the terms of opposing counsel, they would seek full custody and I would have one weekend a month and would continue to file [...]

— ANGIE

42 Oklahoma parents submitted approved, shareable comments. 42 selected excerpts appear here; the full comments begin on the next page.

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS — OKLAHOMA

The comments below are the full approved, publicly shareable survey comments from Oklahoma families. Data-only and do-not-share submissions are excluded from this public appendix.

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

My ex husband was abusive which had been proven, he was also a very absent father after the divorce to our 4 children, he got really behind on child support & refused to pay, so he showed up took our teen son (which was just turning 13 at the time) used him as a weapon against me to make up false allegations & drag me through the court system in order to get out of the legal consequences of not paying child support, he bribed our teen son to say things, he even got temporary protective order and though all professionals that investigated the situation said there was as no truth to what my ex husband was claiming- he was still able to keep my son from myself, and his siblings (the only family he had consistently had in his life) for almost 2 full years without us having any contact. I went from being the only parent that ever cared for him his entire life, to being shoved out of the picture for almost 2 years over false allegations. And the court system allowed all this to happen. Now my son is back home for 2 years now, , my ex-husband was able to get out of all consequences of the back child support owed, has not visited any of his children since and now my son that was used as this weapon in the court system, has severe behavioral and mental health issues that I am now dealing with and trying to help him recover from all the trauma that was caused & allowed by the court system.

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06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

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Going in to this situation, my daughter and I had a healthy, fun and easy going relationship. This ongoing situation has completely destroyed our father/daughter relationship. It has caused extreme emotional duress, strained my marriage, damaged my reputation, and ruined my daughter's relationship with her other siblings. Not to mention the ridiculous amounts of money that has been paid to attorneys that have done nothing, has taken away from the rest of my family. The legal abuse by the opposing party, opposing counsel and GAL has been mind blowing and completely heartbreaking.

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— JEANA

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— MISTY

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— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

Ever since my child was born, even before I've been a domestic abuse situation. The reason I left their situation is because the father my child threatened to kill my grandparents while he was drunk, waving a gun in the air, which pointed at me and my son and I had to grab the end of the barrel before it went off and he kept throwing things and acting crazy. Then we went to court and they said that I was mentally insane and that we had 50-50 custody my evidence was not shared and ignored fast-forward today I have been through domestic view chase down with the car yelled at screamed at throw stuff at but everything is being ignored even with the proof I've had Now today. I am happily married with the baby on the way, but now they're trying to take away my child saying that we abused him which we did not . The other part's mother is coming up the traps working for Dhs. I believe that my son was abused in his father's care and they're trying to blame it on us. There's false allegations and everyone is believing them. I have proof that my son comes back even now bruises, black eyes and busted lip even has came back with broken bones from his dad house while they're on vacation and stayed there not seeking my son at proper casting or care.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has torn my family apart and made me miss out on my only child's life and her most important moments in life and it has made me think of committing suicide. I am lost without my child and she is my reason for living and to be able to have someone who isn't related to your child go to the court house and file false accusations on you and get guardianship of your child and then be told you can't prove them a liar because they won't accept all your evidence to prove that your not what they claim and then be told that I cant have visitation or calls with your child is devastating. My child cries everyday to come home and has told her school counselor she wants to come home and that her step mom is horrible to her and that she kidnapped her just to punish me and my child's father cause he divorced her

— FRANCIS

The family court system did not just fail me — it empowered coercive control, ignored financial abuse, and allowed narratives to replace evidence. I was painted as unstable and uncooperative while being denied access to critical financial information and meaningful due process. The damage was not only legal or financial; it fractured my family and weaponized the very system that was supposed to protect us.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

06 FULL PARENT COMMENTS, CONTINUED

I refused to pay anything but I provided groceries, clothing and all my child needs. My case was very strange. It was the 1st that my child had ever been away from me and the only time she was ever neglected it abused was during her time in foster care. So many things they inflicted on us and it didn't stop there. They also came after my granddaughter bc she lived with me. I've actually had around 21 years of them lying, harassing and falsifying complaints against me but only being able to keep me from my child for about 7-8 months! They were so wrong that I took my child back from the foster home and kept her without any reprimand, that's unheard of but they didn't want exposure is what I'm thinking.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I has threated in front of my counsel who did not come to my aid but opposing counsel in an informal mediation I was pressured into that if I didnt accept the terms of opposing counsel, they would seek full custody and I would have one weekend a month and would continue to file motions until this happened. My son was uprooted from a school he did well at as a neurodivergent child and it has caused problems every since. I am limited in the medical care I can get for my son and its hard to fight for his school rights in this new school because I dont have school decision making authority. You can connect me and I can tell more but my case is stuck in court so I need to protect my identity

— ANGIE

42 full approved Oklahoma comments are included in this appendix.

07 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT**WHAT THIS IS**

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Oklahoma report comes from Oklahoma respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Oklahoma — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 57 Oklahoma families reporting here are not the universe of Oklahoma families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte-Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

STANDWITHMEG.COM · COURAGE TO STAND, POWER TO CHANGE

ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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